but we both stuttered because he couldn’t immediately envisage the run, though it was obvious.

He avoided running me out, and I repaid the favour by running as hard as I have ever done to turn a comfortable two into the three that completed his century. Tension sprayed out of him. He was punching the air, with his bat in his hand, halfway down the wicket on his third run.

That’s international sport, right there. Happiness, insecurity, joy and fear, a mixture of contrasting emotions endured or enjoyed in the space of a couple of minutes. We are always teetering between success and failure: before that innings Trotty had been practising privately with Graham Gooch on a bowling machine, deep in the bowels of the stadium. He was seeking a ray of light in semi-darkness.

Those disparities explain why I love my sport so much. Trying to suck the marrow from the bones of your career is a complex process. Perversely, it is easier to talk about the negative stuff, the hard times, because the accompanying emotions are so raw that they are easily understandable. It is much harder to put it into words when things go well, because the feelings are so individual and intimate.

You strive to be the best you can be, knowing you will never play a perfect innings. You are living to gauge your response to the game’s harshness. The pressure of applying your skills in daunting circumstances is a challenge, a buzz. The feelings are irreplaceable, and impossible to reproduce. That’s probably why so many sportsmen struggle at the end of their career.

People talk about respect in sport, as if it is a demand to genuflect before the athlete. It’s much more subtle than that. Peers express it too, through actions rather than words. You can inspire by example, even in an international dressing room. When we saved that Brisbane Test, you could sense others in that room thinking, ‘This tour and this team will be different.’

At the highest level, sport strips away superficialities, and reveals the essence of the individual.

Confidence bubbles to the surface in unlikely ways, at unexpected junctures. We lost the toss in the next Test, at Adelaide. It was blisteringly hot, and the prospect of a long day in the field was daunting. Within thirteen deliveries, Australia had lost three wickets for two runs. The Brisbane bounce had squashed them.